



SWMS15

Safe Work Method Statement

Work on, in or adjacent to a road, railway, shipping lane or
other traffic corridor in use by traffic other than pedestrians

Document number	EC-SWMS15	Revision	1.0
Prepared by	Ecology Consulting — WHS / Field team	Document release date	
Approved by	Tony Webster — Managing Director / WHS Officer	Next review	

Note: Work must be performed in accordance with this Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS). This SWMS must be kept and available for inspection until the work is completed. If revised, every version must be kept. If a notifiable incident occurs in relation to the work in this SWMS, the SWMS must be kept for at least two years from the date of the notifiable incident. This SWMS is accessed and acknowledged through the Ecology Consulting digital WHS platform; field forms are submitted from site and reviewed centrally by the administration team.

Scope & limitations: Works are limited to ecological survey and observation activities only. **Ecology Consulting personnel will not undertake traffic control, operate plant, or interfere with traffic management systems unless appropriately trained and authorised.** Traffic Management Plans (TMP) and Traffic Guidance Schemes (TGS) are developed and implemented by a qualified traffic control provider engaged by the Principal Contractor. A safe buffer distance from live traffic lanes must be maintained at all times in accordance with the approved TGS.

Project & PCBU details

Person conducting a business or undertaking (PCBU)	Ecology Consulting Pty Ltd · ABN 68 647 633 163	Contact number	0472 569 988 (office / Check-in)
EC offices	34 Atchison St, Wollongong NSW 2500 · 42 Goulburn St, Crookwell NSW 2583 · 473 Townsend St, Albury NSW 2640		
Client / Principal Contractor			
Work activity	Ecological survey, pre-clearing survey, flora and fauna survey and clearing supervision on, in or adjacent to road and rail corridors in use by traffic.		
Workplace location			

Field work duration

Legislation, codes of practice & standards

Acts & Regulations	Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (NSW) and the Work Health and Safety Regulation (NSW); Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (Cth) and WHS Regulations 2011 (Cth) where work is on Commonwealth land or for a Commonwealth entity (Comcare jurisdiction); Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (ACT) and WHS Regulation 2011 (ACT) for works in the ACT.
Codes of Practice	Safe Work Australia model Codes as adopted in NSW and the ACT: <i>How to manage work health and safety risks; Work health and safety consultation, cooperation and coordination; Construction work; First aid in the workplace; Managing the work environment and facilities; Preparation of safe work method statements for construction work. Traffic management in workplaces; Managing risks of plant in the workplace; Managing electrical risks in the workplace.</i>
Standards & guidance	AS/NZS 4602 High visibility safety garments (to road or rail authority requirements); AS 1742.3 Traffic control for works on roads; AS/NZS 1801 Occupational protective helmets; AS 1319 Safety signs. Rail Industry Worker (RIW) or ARTC induction requirements where applicable.
EC WHS documentation	EC Work Health and Safety Management System and WHS Handbook; EC Risk Management Processes (EC-RMP-FRM-001); EC Hazard Register and Trigger Action Response List (TARL); Pre-Mobilisation Checklist; Pre-Travel Vehicle Safety Checklist; Journey Management Plan; Daily Toolbox Talk; site-specific Emergency Response Plan (ERP); JSA — General Field Surveys; JSA — Remote and Isolated Work; SOP — Journey Management; SOP — Terrestrial Fauna; SOP — Fieldwork Biosecurity. SWMS16 — Work in an area with movement of powered mobile plant; SWMS12 — Work on or near energised electrical installations or services; project Construction Environmental Management Plan (CEMP).

Mandatory personal protective equipment & field equipment

Confirmed present and serviceable on the Pre-Mobilisation Checklist and verified by the Field Lead at the Daily Toolbox Talk. Faulty items are tagged out and removed from service.

Hard Hat	Safety Glasses	Gloves	Hearing Protection	Hi-Vis Clothing	Sun Safe PPE	Wide Brim Hat	Capped Boots
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Fire Extinguisher	Remote First Aid Kit	Snake Bite Kit	In Reach / Sat Phone	Two-Way Radio	Torch / Headlamp	GPS	Drinking Water
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Rail-Spec Hi-Vis (rail work)	RIW / ARTC Card	Two-Way Radio (TC channel)	Approved TMP / TGS	Site Induction Card	Task Lighting (low light)	Dust Mask	Spotter Vest
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Hierarchy of controls

Eliminate	Avoid working within live traffic corridors wherever practicable by redesigning survey methods — undertake surveys from outside the corridor, use remote observation tools, or rely on existing data and desktop assessment.
Substitute	Use safer work methods that reduce exposure to moving traffic — conduct surveys during traffic closures or rail possessions, work from designated safe areas, or alter survey timing to low-traffic periods where approved.
Isolate	Establish and maintain physical separation between workers and live traffic using approved TMPs and TGSs, exclusion zones, barriers, cones, fencing and delineated pedestrian pathways; restrict access to danger zones and live lanes at all times.
Engineer	Use engineered controls implemented by the Principal Contractor or traffic authority such as temporary barriers, bollards, crash-rated protection, controlled access points, defined crossings, and lookout or rail protection systems.
Administrative	SWMS, site-specific risk assessments, traffic and rail inductions, permits and approvals (road, rail or port authority as applicable), TMPs and TGSs prepared by qualified providers, communication protocols, supervision, lookout or traffic controller arrangements, fatigue management, and strict stop-work triggers.
PPE	Last line of defence only — high visibility clothing compliant with road or rail authority requirements, safety boots, helmets where required, eye protection and hearing protection. PPE must not be relied upon as the primary control for traffic risk.

Hazards & controls

Complete daily. Work must not commence without confirmed approvals and verified traffic controls.

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Planning, preparation and travelling to site		
Inadequate planning leading to uncontrolled risk; unfit or untrained personnel	Attend the pre-field meeting with the Project Lead and Project Manager to review scope, methodology and expected hazards; confirm site access, keys, codes, inductions and property constraints; and confirm all staff are trained, competent and fit for work. Medical concerns are disclosed privately to the Field Lead. Review this SWMS, the relevant JSA and SOP, the Field Plan and the site-specific ERP. Verify training currency — workers are not mobilised with expired mandatory training.	☐ Pre-field meeting ☐ SWMS / JSA / SOP reviewed ☐ ERP reviewed ☐ Training verified ☐ Medical disclosures
Vehicle failure, missing safety equipment or fatigue during travel	Complete the Pre-Travel Vehicle Safety Checklist — first aid kit, extinguisher, spare tyre, torch, water and PPE present; vehicle free from leaks, faults or damage; electrical issues visually inspected only and tagged out if unsafe. Complete the Journey Management Plan. Minimum 10-hour rest between shifts before driving; personal fatigue self-assessment before departure; rest breaks every two hours; carry water, snacks and electrolytes; second driver for long or remote trips where practicable. Zero blood alcohol concentration applies to all work driving.	☐ Vehicle checklist done ☐ JMP completed ☐ 10-hr rest confirmed ☐ Fatigue self-assessment
Travelling into fire, flood, storm, smoke or hazardous road conditions	Complete the Pre-Travel Environmental and Hazard Check using BOM weather warnings, Hazards Near Me, RFS fire danger ratings, Air Quality Index, lightning trackers, Live Traffic NSW and telecommunications coverage maps. Do not travel where there are emergency warning fire events, hazardous air quality, active storm warnings or flooded roads. Never drive through floodwater under any circumstance. If conditions change, stop, reassess and notify the Communication Officer.	☐ BOM / Hazards Near Me ☐ RFS rating checked ☐ AQI checked ☐ Live Traffic NSW ☐ Coverage checked
Hazards not identified, assessed or communicated before work commences	All team members participate in a pre-commencement Daily Toolbox Talk led on site by the Field Lead and documented on the EC WHS form — site-specific hazards identified; collaborative risk assessment using the EC risk matrix (rating one to six) with agreed controls and a revised residual rating; PPE and equipment readiness confirmed; ERP reviewed and Emergency Meeting Point identified; communication and check-in requirements confirmed; health or access needs disclosed privately; and worker sign-on confirming understanding and fitness for work. Hazards already in the EC Hazard Register are managed under the TARL. No worker commences without sign-on.	☐ Toolbox talk held ☐ Risk assessment rated ☐ Emergency Meeting Point ☐ All workers signed on
Loss of contact with the field team; delayed emergency response	Mandatory check-ins with the Communication Officer (0472 569 988) before departing base, on arrival at site or accommodation, before leaving site, and on return to base. Every check-in must be acknowledged. A missed or unacknowledged check-in triggers escalation through the Communication Officer, Project Lead or Project Manager, and the WHS Officer, and is grounds for activating the ERP. Carry redundant communications — mobile phone, UHF radio and In Reach or satellite communicator, with a PLB where remoteness warrants. Roles are assigned at the toolbox talk: Field Lead, Communication Officer and workers.	☐ Check-in schedule agreed ☐ Comms tested ☐ Roles assigned ☐ Escalation briefed
Pre-planning and approvals		

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Inadequate planning leading to vehicle strike or site incident; unauthorised work within traffic corridors; missing approvals or non-compliant traffic management	Complete the daily SWMS, JSA and toolbox briefing prior to works. The Principal Contractor must obtain all required approvals, for example consent authority approval, Roads Act Section 138 consent and Rail Authority approvals. A Traffic Management Plan and Traffic Guidance Scheme must be developed and implemented by a qualified traffic control provider. Ecology personnel must review and understand traffic controls prior to entering the work area. Work must not commence without confirmed approvals and controls.	☐ Approvals confirmed & sighted ☐ TMP / TGS implemented ☐ Pre-start completed ☐ Controls understood
Arrival, parking and working adjacent to live traffic		
Vehicle rollover or instability on soft edges and embankments; vehicle strike from passing traffic; bogging or loss of control	Identify and use designated safe parking areas away from traffic lanes, and from soft ground, embankments and culverts. Park within the delineated work area where one exists, facing out for safe egress. Do not reverse onto or off a live carriageway.	☐ Safe parking established ☐ Within delineated area ☐ No reversing onto road
Worker struck by passing vehicle; vehicle entering the work zone; reduced driver visibility	Traffic controls must be installed prior to work commencement and only an approved TGS implemented by qualified personnel is to be used. Ecology staff must remain within designated work zones only. High visibility PPE must be worn at all times. The Field Lead must verify traffic controls via a site inspection prior to starting work. Maintain a safe buffer distance from live traffic lanes at all times in accordance with the approved TGS. Stop work if traffic controls are missing, damaged or ineffective.	☐ Traffic controls verified ☐ Hi-vis worn ☐ Buffer distance kept ☐ Within designated zone
Distraction leading to encroachment into traffic; slips and trips near the road edge; reduced situational awareness during data collection	Maintain constant awareness of the traffic environment. Do not walk while recording data — stop in a safe location. Remain within designated safe work areas and use safe access paths only. Stop work if traffic risk increases. Never turn your back to live traffic when working near the lane edge.	☐ Safe positioning maintained ☐ Stop to record data ☐ Safe access paths only
Public or vehicles entering the active worksite; exposure to uncontrolled traffic hazards	Ensure clear delineation of the work area using barriers, cones and signage. Traffic control personnel manage site entry and exit points. Prevent public access into active work zones and monitor site boundaries continuously. Only certified traffic controllers are permitted to direct traffic — Ecology personnel must not undertake traffic control.	☐ Site secured ☐ Access managed ☐ No traffic control by EC
Unexpected vehicle entry from private driveways; conflict with local traffic	Maintain awareness of driveway access points and mark them on the TGS. Traffic controllers assist vehicles entering and exiting. Ensure residents maintain safe access at all times. Adjust controls to maintain traffic flow safely.	☐ Driveways identified ☐ Resident access kept
Plant, communication and coordination		
Workers struck by plant or site vehicles; pedestrian interaction with moving plant; reversing plant blind spots	Ecology personnel must remain clear of operating plant at all times. Establish and maintain exclusion zones around plant. Use spotters for vehicle and plant movement where required. Maintain clear separation between pedestrian pathways and plant zones. Do not approach plant unless the operator has acknowledged your presence. Refer to SWMS16 for further controls.	☐ Separation maintained ☐ Spotter used ☐ Operator acknowledgement ☐ SWMS16 applied
Miscommunication leading to incident; delay in emergency response	Establish clear communication protocols with traffic control, plant operators and rail control where applicable. Nominate a responsible communication lead. Test communication systems prior to work and maintain continuous communication during activities.	☐ Comms tested ☐ Comms lead nominated ☐ Continuous contact
Environmental conditions and fatigue		

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Reduced visibility from dust, rain, fog or smoke; increased vehicle stopping distance; worker exposure to traffic risk	Monitor weather conditions continuously. Stop work if visibility is reduced or unsafe. Adjust controls based on environmental conditions and increase buffer distances where required. In night or low-light conditions, additional lighting is required, or work stops if visibility is insufficient.	☐ Conditions monitored ☐ Buffer increased ☐ Lighting adequate
Reduced awareness and slower reaction times near traffic due to fatigue	Implement work and rest cycles. Rotate tasks where possible. Workers must be fit for duty. Stop work if fatigue impacts safety and notify the Communication Officer.	☐ Fatigue managed ☐ Tasks rotated ☐ Fit for duty
Rail corridor access and protection		
Struck by train; unauthorised entry into a rail danger zone; miscommunication with rail operators	All personnel must hold a valid rail induction such as RIW or ARTC. Work only within an approved possession or authorised access period. The Principal Contractor must obtain written approval from the Rail Authority. Ecology personnel must remain outside rail danger zones unless authorised. Identify and communicate safe zones and danger zones prior to work.	☐ Rail approval confirmed ☐ Induction valid ☐ Danger zones identified
Unexpected train movement; delayed evacuation	A qualified Lookout Protection Officer or Rail Safety Officer must be present. Establish safe retreat areas prior to commencing work. Maintain continuous communication with rail control. Cease work immediately on warning and move to the nominated retreat area.	☐ Lookout in place ☐ Retreat areas set ☐ Cease-on-warning briefed
Collision with a train while crossing; vehicle stalling or delay on tracks	Only cross at designated crossings, one vehicle at a time. Use a spotter where required. Confirm the crossing is clear before proceeding and maintain communication during the crossing. Never stop or queue on a level crossing.	☐ Crossing controlled ☐ One vehicle at a time ☐ Crossing confirmed clear
Miscommunication with Train Control or Network Operations; conflicting instructions; unauthorised train movements; delayed response to changing conditions	The Principal Contractor and Site Supervisor must establish a formal communication protocol with Train Control or Network Operations prior to commencing work. A dedicated and competent communicator must be nominated for the duration of works. All instructions, authorities and changes to conditions must be clearly communicated, acknowledged and recorded. Communication systems must be tested prior to work commencing. Work must cease immediately if communication with Train Control is lost or unclear.	☐ Protocol confirmed ☐ Communicator assigned ☐ Comms tested ☐ Instructions recorded
Electrocution or arc flash from overhead electrical (rail or road); contact with overhead lines	Maintain minimum safe approach distances at all times. Do not work under or near live conductors unless safe distances are maintained. Do not raise equipment into exclusion zones. Stop work if unsure of safe distances or conditions. Refer to SWMS12.	☐ Electrical separation maintained ☐ Equipment kept low ☐ SWMS12 applied
Emergency planning and environment		
Delayed or ineffective response to incidents; workers unable to safely evacuate	The Site Supervisor must ensure a site-specific Emergency Response Plan is developed, current and communicated to all personnel. Emergency exits, safe retreat areas and muster points must be identified and communicated prior to work. An emergency contact list must be available onsite and understood. All Ecology personnel must be briefed on emergency procedures and stop-work triggers. A fully stocked first aid kit must be available onsite at all times. Emergency arrangements are reviewed during the daily toolbox talk.	☐ ERP briefed ☐ Muster points identified ☐ Contact list available ☐ First aid available

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Damage to sensitive rail-side or road-side vegetation; disturbance or injury to fauna; non-compliance with environmental approvals	All works must comply with the CEMP and any project-specific environmental approvals. Sensitive vegetation and fauna habitats must be identified and avoided where practicable. Ecological works must minimise disturbance within the corridor. Any unexpected environmental impacts, fauna injuries or habitat damage must be reported immediately to the Site Supervisor. Stop work if environmental risks cannot be adequately controlled.	☐ CEMP reviewed ☐ Constraints identified ☐ Impacts reported

Stop-work triggers — stop work immediately, move to a safe location, notify the Field Lead and Principal Contractor, and do not recommence until the risk is controlled and communicated

Traffic controls missing, incorrect or not implemented	Breach of the work zone by vehicles or the public	Loss of communication with traffic or rail control	Reduced visibility affecting safety
Train warning received or unauthorised train movement	Plant breaches an exclusion zone	Night or low-light conditions without adequate lighting	Any situation where a worker feels unsafe

Emergency response

Read with the site-specific Emergency Response Plan. The Field Lead is the Chief Warden. Any worker may activate the ERP.

1 · Activate & make safe	Stop work and ensure the area is safe for responders. Do not move an injured person unless there is immediate danger. Where an incident occurs within a live corridor, move to the nominated safe retreat area or muster point before rendering assistance — do not enter a live lane or rail danger zone. Traffic control or rail control must confirm the corridor is protected before responders approach. The Field Lead assesses the situation, initiates the response, directs evacuation to the Emergency Meeting Point, accounts for all personnel using the Daily Toolbox Talk sign-on sheet, and coordinates communication with the office.
2 · Call for help	Call 000 or 112, or activate the In Reach or PLB where there is no coverage. Provide GPS coordinates and the nearest cross roads, the nature of the emergency and safe access routes. Assign one person to guide responders in.
3 · First aid	A trained first aider assesses the casualty, but only where it is safe to do so. Control bleeding, immobilise suspected fractures and monitor breathing. If unconscious but breathing, place in the recovery position; if not breathing, commence CPR. Record all treatment on the First Aid Treatment Log.
4 · Post-incident	Report to the WHS Officer and complete an Incident Report Form within the required timeframe, submitted through the digital WHS platform. The WHS Officer updates the Incident Register and notifies the regulator of any notifiable incident. Attend debrief; review and update this SWMS and the ERP; restock emergency equipment used. Psychosocial support is provided where workers were exposed to distressing events.

Emergency services	000 or 112	State Emergency Service (SES)	13 25 00
EC office / Check-in Officer	0472 569 988	Managing Director / WHS Officer	Tony Webster · 0448 439 334
Poisons Information Hotline	13 11 26	Wildlife rescue	1300 094 737
Employee Assistance Program	1300 172 327 — free and confidential	Nearest hospital & muster point	Identified per site in the ERP; confirmed at the toolbox talk

Training & competency requirements

Required for this activity	White Card (General Construction Induction) is mandatory. A valid rail induction (RIW or ARTC) is mandatory for all rail corridor work. Road and rail site-specific inductions must be completed before entry. Ecology personnel must not perform traffic control unless they hold current traffic control certification and are authorised to do so.
Baseline — all field personnel	White Card (General Construction Induction); current driver's licence of appropriate class; CPR certification (annual renewal); Provide First Aid (HLTAID011), and Remote First Aid (HLTAID013) for remote or isolated work; General Fauna Handling Training.
Verification	All training must be current, recorded and verifiable prior to mobilisation. Records are maintained by the Administration Officer and retained for a minimum of five years, with expiry notifications issued in advance; workers are not mobilised with expired mandatory training. Competency is verified annually and observed on site by Principal or Senior Ecologists, Project Managers and the WHS Officer. Subcontractor training evidence is collected and retained for audit.

Daily SWMS acknowledgement & sign-on register

All personnel must read, understand and sign this SWMS before commencing work, confirming they are fit for duty, competent and able to perform assigned tasks safely. Completed with the Daily Toolbox Talk and submitted through the digital WHS platform.

#	Name	Role	Signature	Date
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

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